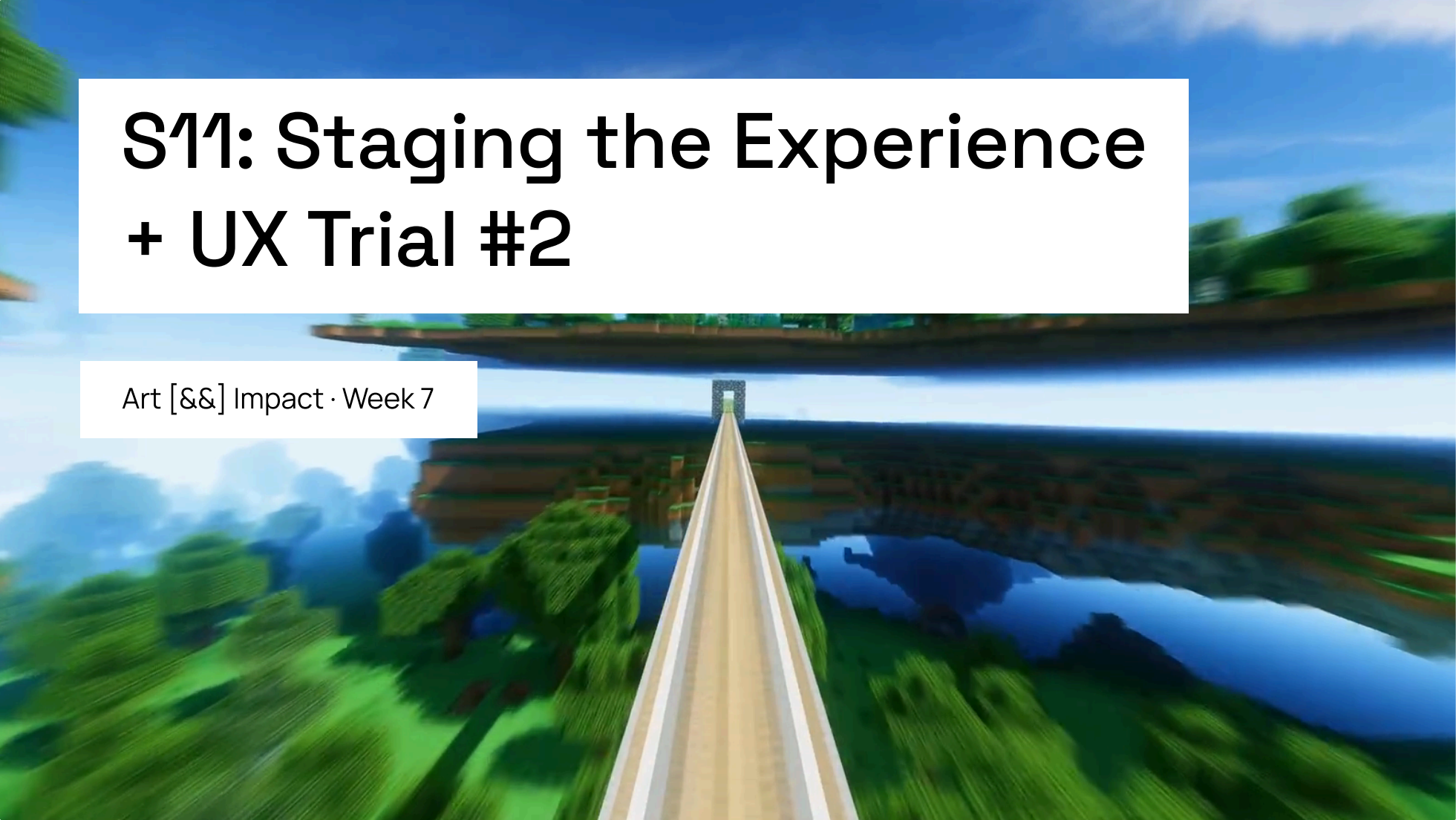


S11: Staging the Experience + UX Trial #2

Art [&&] Impact · Week 7



In This Session

BLOCK	CONTENT	DURATION	AI ZONE
Lecture	Staging the Experience	60 min	● No AI
Group Work	Self Structured Prep for UX Trial #2	30 min	● Brain-first
🍷 Lunch	—	—	—
UX Trial #2	14:00 - 15:30 Two audience waves	90 min	● No AI
Group Work	Self Structured Group Work	120 min	● Brain-first

We're decreasing structured time as we get closer to the exhibition.

Where We Are

← LAST WEEK (S10)

Mid-Process Review Workshop

Silent peer observation ... not so silent, but it was worth a shot.

Be mindful to stay in observation mode rather than going into explanation mode in your trials!

 TODAY (S11)

Staging the Experience + UX Trial #2

How your installation vibes with the space around it · Second UX trial

Core interaction should be testable

→ NEXT (S12)

Critique + Portfolio Workshop

Group critique · Portfolio work · Stepping up space and tech logistics

Phase 3 planning starts!

Reminder: Phase 2 Arc

UX TRIAL #1

S8 · Week 5 · Fri afternoon

Paper prototyping, sketches, Miro boards, roleplay, conceptual walkthrough, ...

No built prototype required.

Does your design question produce the intended experience — even on paper?

UX TRIAL #2

S11 · Week 7 · Fri afternoon

Working interaction expected.
Structured feedback.

Something that runs.

≠ a fully working thing!

Does the interaction do what you designed it to do?

UX TRIAL #3

S14 · Week 8 · Fri afternoon

Iteration of your most important interaction. Phase 2 closes here.

Exhibition-ready planning.

At this point you have a tested plan for your art installation; ready to turn complete in Phase 3.

Each trial should answer a question. Each answer makes your plan more concrete. That plan is executed in Phase 3!

From Prototype to Installation

Your artwork is more than the sum of its (prototyped) parts!

Staging

SPACE

How far away people start, and what they pass through to reach you.

SOUND

What is heard before, during, and instead of interaction.

LIGHT

What is visible, and whether your image survives the room it is in.

PEOPLE

What happens when more (or fewer) people arrive?

...AND THE UNEXPECTED VISITOR

The one you did not design for.
Often in the majority 😊

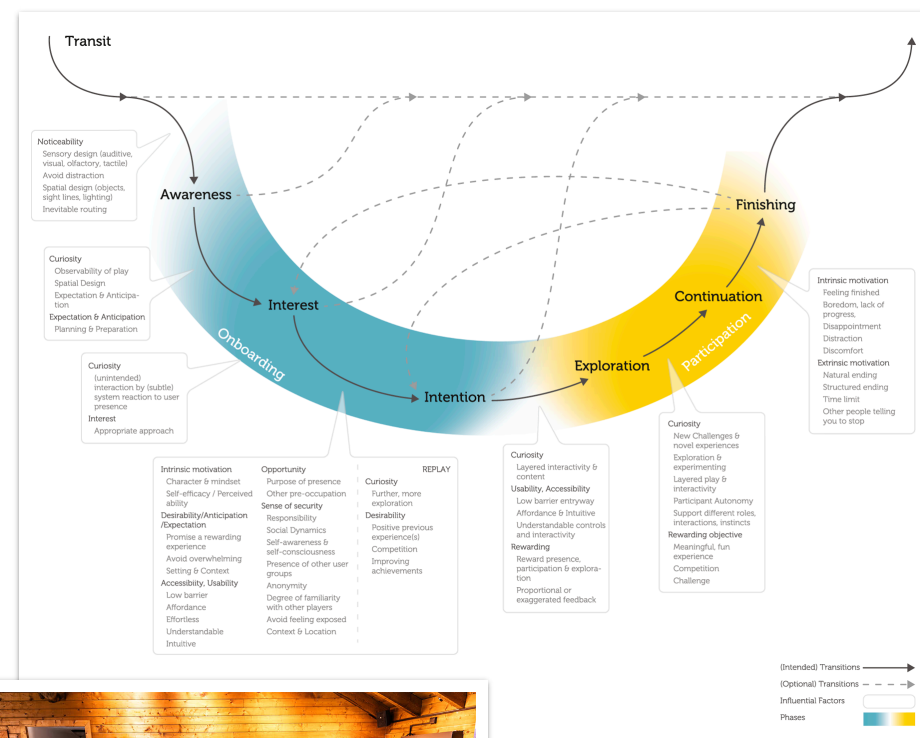
Your work will be evaluated also by how the audience enters and exits your exhibition space, and how your installation impacts their general experience!

Spatial Composition

The audience starts 'reading' your work before they're even fully in it. The approach itself is part of it!

- **Distance:** how close do people get before something invites them in?
- **Scale:** body scale, screen scale, or room scale? Each asks for a different posture.
- **Approach path:** what do they see, hear, and feel in the last ten seconds before arriving?
- **First encounter:** the work has to teach its own interaction. There is no manual and no one standing next to it explaining.

If people need you to explain how to start, the experience starts as 'getting taught' rather than interacting.



Staging: Sound

Sound reaches people before anything else does.

Sound and Noise in a Shared Room

AMBIENT VS. REACTIVE

Ambient audio sets the mood before anyone interacts. It is always on.

Reactive audio answers a presence or an action. If it is reactive: what exactly sets it off? Does it get annoying?

DIRECTIONAL CHOICES

Headphones: intimate and isolating. Should be intentional.

Open speakers: shared and environmental, but they bleed into the work next to yours.

SILENCE IS A CHOICE TOO

In a loud exhibition, a deliberate quiet moment can carry more weight than increasing the amount further. But it should read as intentional; and can only be 'relative'

Your sound does not stop at your footprint! Think of containment strategies.

Staging: Light

What should be seen; what should be hidden?

Light and Projection in a Shared Room

PROJECTION NEEDS DARKNESS (DUH)

The darkest black is only as dark as ambient light. Colors wash out in a bright space. Check if the trade-off is worth it compared to a tablet or screen.

Even in the dark space, a shielded corner makes sense.

Consider options where people look into a box if fuller darkness is needed.

THE ROOM IS NOT NEUTRAL

Light from the installation next to yours spills into yours. Design for imperfect conditions, not an empty test room.

Light directs attention: where do you want people to look first? Use brightness, shadows, or color to direct people and set the mood.

Consider also that light might look harsh or uncomfortable from some angles; this can make some areas unintentionally unpleasant.

Staging: People

You designed it for one person.

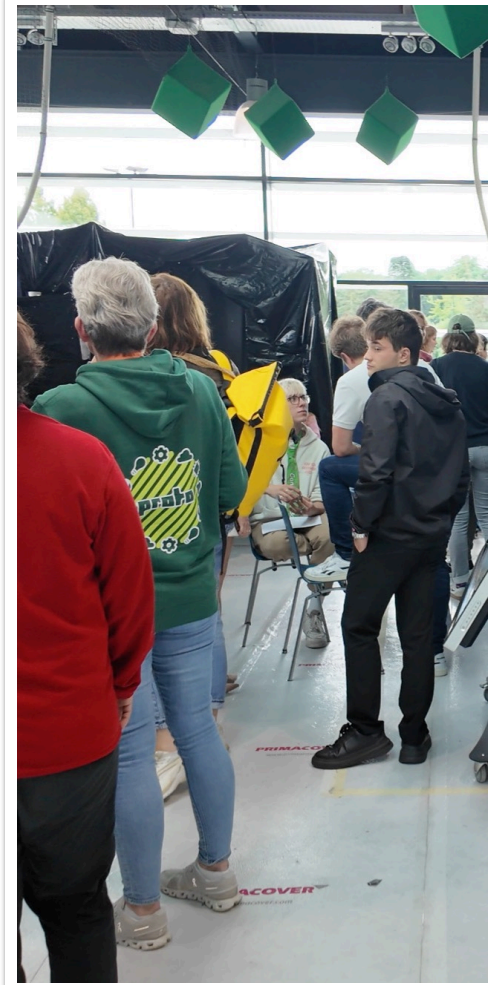
Three are about to arrive together...

Audience Dynamics

A piece designed for one is rarely met by one. Plan for arrivals you did not script.

- **Solo:** the case you already designed for (or needs to find someone else suddenly)
- **Pair or group:** who acts, who watches, who waits? Does your art installation still work when three people crowd around it?
- **The observer effect:** does being watched change how the active person behaves? Sometimes that is the point. Sometimes it kills the experience.
- **The queue:** waiting is also an experience you are designing. What do the people in line see and feel?

A passive moment next to your artwork can still be part of it!



Audience Flow

We're not just filling a space; we're designing how people move through it!

- **Clarity = Comfort!** When people know how to enter an installation, they're more likely to engage
- **Entry cues** – can people tell where to go or stand?
- **Multiple modes of interactions** – can a person actively use it while others watch and still feel included?
- **Timing and pacing** – how long does it take people? How do you handle multiple people in sequence?
- **Exit strategy** – how do people know when an experience has concluded?
- **Crowd control** – can it run without explanation or reset? Can waiting be part of an experience?



The Unexpected Visitor

Edge cases can be surprisingly revealing!

Edge Cases as Design Material

THE UNINTENDED USER

Someone interacts in a way you did not imagine. Different body, different reading, different culture.

Does the piece still mean something, or only work for the ideal visitor?

THE SHY ONE

Someone stands at the edge and will not step in. Watching is their whole engagement.

Did you design anything for the person who only observes?

THE ANARCHIST

Someone breaks the interaction on purpose or by accident. Does the system recover?

A piece that only survives correct use is fragile.

*These three are good test conditions to consider today.
Watch for them in UX Trial #2.*

D4E: Helps You With Testing

BORROW FROM D4E

D4E gave you an evaluation toolkit: the **PAD** dimensions (Pleasure, Arousal, Dominance), think-aloud, observation, UX curves.

This is not all just exam material 😊

USE PAD TO READ YOUR CARDS

When a visitor writes “*I felt...*”, PAD gives you language to interpret it: was it pleasant or not, calm or activated, in control or overwhelmed?

Not about academic language; it's just more precise than “*they liked it.*” — how activated was that *liking*?

*Staging is
collaborative!*

*What are the
approach paths
for different
artworks?*

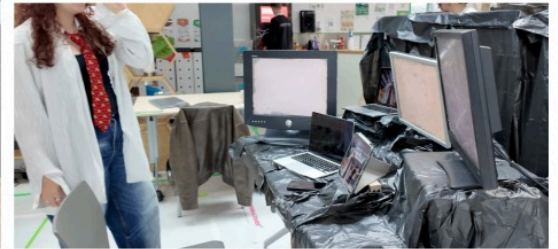
*Which can be
experienced by
multiple people?*

*How is sound and
light handled?*



AAAI in 2024

Thoughts?



Equipment List! Already Started?

Have a crucial requirement? Post with `@group-id` in your MS Teams group so we get a notification!

INSTALLATION NEEDS

- Estimated power draw (roughly)
- Internet: yes / no / offline fallback?
- Noise: silent / ambient / loud
- Dark space or light space?
- ... what else?

WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

- Own hardware (laptops, cameras, controllers, etc.)
- Own materials (physical, printed, fabric, etc.)
- Anything already sourced or borrowed

WHAT YOU STILL NEED TO FIND

- Equipment to borrow from the Interaction Lab or SmartXP
- Shared resources: flag in Teams
- Transport: DesignLab → BlackBrick
We're trying to arrange options too

*Make sure that you have access to equipment that is crucial to your installation idea!
E.g. projectors! We try our best to support you, but resources are limited 😊*

SUTQ Persona Feedback

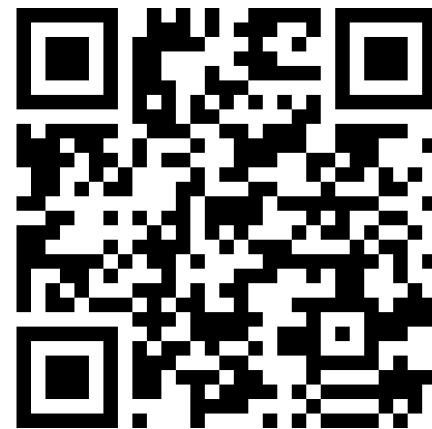
Still looking for feedback 🙏🙏

Recall your **experience of the GenAI Persona Workshop**.

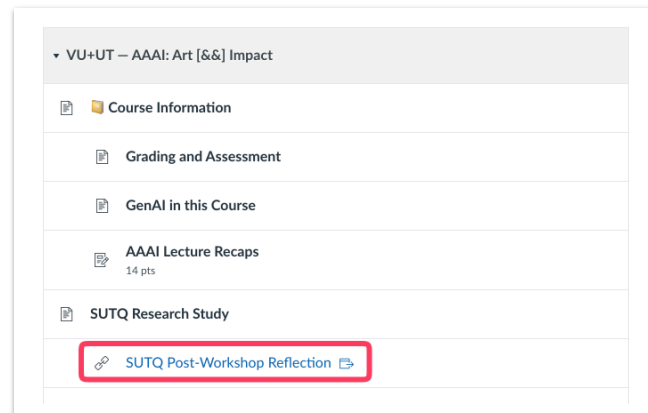
Especially at VU – no participants so far 😞

Maro would like to interview some of you in the upcoming 2 weeks.

Give Maro a poke if you're up for that (Mail, Teams, in person).



SUTQ: Workshop Survey



You can find the link also on Canvas!



Lunch

UX Trial #2

Core interaction should be testable today!

What Is Different From Trial #1

 UX TRIAL #1

S8 · Week 5

Paper, sketches, walkthrough. **No built prototype required.**

Does the idea hold on paper?

 UX TRIAL #2 (TODAY)

S11 · Week 7

Something that runs. Core interaction works, concept is recognisable in the experience.

Does the interaction do what you designed?

 UX TRIAL #3

S14 · Week 8

Iteration of your key interaction. Phase 2 closes here.

Exhibition-ready plan.

Visitors should experience something working today, not a description anymore

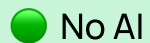
UX Trial #2 Schedule

TIME	BLOCK
14:00–14:40	Trial Wave 1
14:40–14:50	Quick Changes · Swap
14:50–15:30	Trial Wave 2

- Half the team runs the piece; the other half visits other teams
- **Everyone should visit and respond to every other team**
- Collect feedback that you can use for your UX Trial report

UX Trial #2:

Two Waves + Synthesis



No AI



40 min

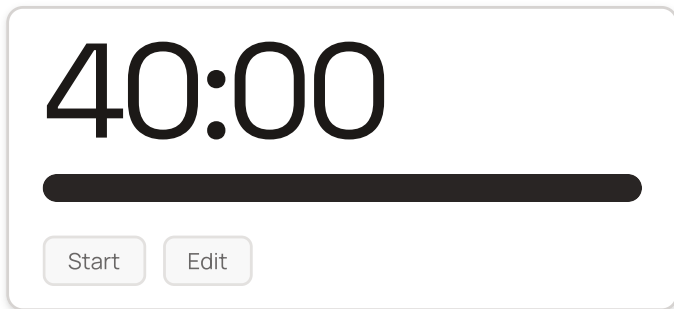
Wave 1 starts at 14:00. Set up until we begin.

Trial Wave 1 14:00–14:40

Half your team runs the piece. The other half visits other teams.

Remember the various exercises we tried out and use what you found helpful.

Same goes for the tools you learned about in D4E!



Swap

The half that visited now runs the piece. The others visit.

10:00



Start

Edit

Trial Wave 2 14:50–15:30

The half that visited now runs the piece. The others visit.

40:00

StartEdit

UX Trial Report Format (reminder)

Doesn't have to have these headers; but should contain this information!

1 · QUESTION TESTED

What specific design question was this trial investigating?

2 · METHOD USED

How did you try to answer it? What did you observe or ask?

3 · FINDING

What did you actually observe or hear?

4 · CHANGE MADE

What did you decide to do differently as a result?

*Report these in your **Notion Portfolio!** Sketches, visuals, words ...*

Self Structured Group Work

Your turn! But don't forget...

- **UX Trial documentation** — integrate in Notion portfolio!
- **AI & Me entries** — two entries across the 2nd phase; submitted on Canvas
- **For next week** — Installation concept and Technical Decisions parts of your portfolio

Section	Content	Submission
UX Trial Reports	A minimum of three UX Trial Reports. Each report is not just a summary of comments but a documented work-improvement cycle. A specific question you entered the trial with, what you observed based on testing with an audience, and what you decided to do as a result. The three reports should convey a progression, not just three isolated events. Report #1 (conceptual trial): What design question were you testing? What did you observe? What changed as a result? Report #2 (early prototyping): What changed since Report #1? What did you find this round? Report #3 (medium fidelity): What changed since Report #2? What did you find this round? What remains unresolved, and is that a design choice or a development constraint? If the concept changed significantly between trials, that change should be made explicit in the report — acknowledge it rather than smoothing it over.	• Minimum • Each rep • Each rep • Each rep
Installation Concept	A description of the installation as it stands at the end of the phase: concept, interaction design, spatial plan, and intended audience experience. This is not a repeat of your Phase 1 artistic statement; it is the concept as it has been shaped by three rounds of testing. It should be specific enough that someone who has not seen the work can understand what the experience will be. Relationship to Phase 1: Your Phase 1 artistic statement is your 'anchor' for your art work. The installation concept is how your statement has turned into practice. Note explicitly how the concept has evolved — what is the same, what changed, and why. Audience scenario: Describe what a visitor actually does when they encounter the installation — not what you hope they feel, but the sequence of events and choices the work sets up for them.	• Working • Premise • Audience • Spatial • Note on
Technical Decisions	A record of important technical choices you made during Phase 2 — not a reproduction manual, but an account of your reasoning. The audience for this page is someone who wants to understand why the work was made the way it was, not someone trying to rebuild it. For each significant decision, document: what options you considered, what you chose, and why. If a technical constraint forced a change to the concept, say so — that kind of honesty is more useful than a "too-perfect" narrative 1. Technology track and tools — which tools, libraries, or environments you are using, and why. 2. Key interaction decisions — at least one significant design decision about how the installation responds to or involves its audience. What you considered, what you chose, and why. 3. Known risks or constraints — what is not yet resolved and how you plan to address it in the next phase	• Technol • At least • Known

*As described in the assignment
submission on Canvas*

Art [88] Impact

See you at S12, Week 8, Monday!